THE BLACKHEARTS

Equipment Durability & Wear — Player Rules

Weapons, armor, and shields in the Gloombough are valuable possessions. Their condition matters, and even exceptional equipment can be worn down, damaged, or destroyed. These rules establish the **baseline durability** of common equipment and the usual causes of wear.

I. Baseline Durability

The following values represent equipment of **Good material quality and Good craftsmanship**, with no positive or negative durability modifiers. Durability is an item-condition score, not additional creature hit points. Material and craftsmanship modifiers from the Blackhearts crafting rules apply to these baselines.

Simple Melee Weapons

Weapon	Durability	Weapon	Durability
Club	40	Dagger	35
Greatclub	70	Handaxe	55
Javelin	40	Light Hammer	55
Mace	65	Quarterstaff	60
Sickle	40	Spear	50

Martial Melee Weapons

Weapon	Durability	Weapon	Durability
Battleaxe	70	Flail	55
Glaive	65	Greataxe	80
Greatsword	85	Halberd	70
Lance	55	Longsword	65
Maul	90	Morningstar	70
Pike	65	Rapier	45
Scimitar	55	Shortsword	50
Trident	65	Warhammer	80
War Pick	70	Whip	30

Ranged Weapons

Weapon	Durability	Weapon	Durability
Dart	15	Light Crossbow	50
Shortbow	40	Sling	25
Blowgun	30	Hand Crossbow	40
Heavy Crossbow	70	Longbow	50
Musket*	65		

**Musket availability is subject to the DM and the technological limits of the setting. Pistols are not included.*

II. Armor & Shields

Armor	Durability	Armor	Durability
Padded	50	Leather	65
Studded Leather	75	Hide	70
Chain Shirt	90	Scale Mail	105
Breastplate	110	Half Plate	125
Ring Mail	110	Chain Mail	130
Splint	145	Plate	160
Shield	80		

Separate helmets typically have **40–75 durability**, depending on construction. Their specific protective effects are determined by the DM. Nonmetal materials follow their own material properties as those rules are established.

III. Applying Durability Modifiers

Durability bonuses and penalties from material type, individual material quality, and craftsmanship are **cumulative and additive**. Calculate the total percentage, then multiply it by the item's baseline durability. Round fractional results to the nearest whole point.

Example — Masterwork Steel Longsword: A longsword has 65 baseline durability. Steel grants +25%, Masterwork material quality grants +25%, and Masterwork craftsmanship grants +25%. Total durability is 175% of baseline: **65 × 1.75 = 113.75, rounded to 114**.

IV. Durability Loss

Ordinary successful attacks do not automatically reduce durability. The following are the standard durability-loss events:

Event	Durability Lost
Ordinary successful attack	0
Natural 1 on an attack roll	1d4
Weapon used to parry a critical hit	1d6
Armor absorbs a critical hit	1d6
Shield blocks a critical hit	1d8
Severe environmental exposure	1d4–2d6
Deliberate equipment destruction	Based on attack and material

DM discretion: These are not the only possible sources of durability loss. Other circumstances—including unusual attacks, hazardous terrain, mishandling, prolonged exposure, traps, or narrative events—may damage equipment at the DM's discretion. The DM determines when such damage applies and how much durability is lost.

V. Maintenance, Repairs & Destruction

Equipment should be maintained and repaired before it becomes unusable. An item reduced to **0 durability is permanently destroyed**. Repair requires an appropriately skilled artisan: a repairer may be no more than one quality grade below the item. Each repair ordinarily reduces maximum durability by 1; repairs by a lower-grade artisan reduce it by 2. Higher-grade artisans may avoid this loss, with the chance determined by their grade advantage under the full crafting rules.

Some natural weapons and equipment made from stone, bone, or obsidian **cannot be repaired once damaged**, as established in the material rules. Other materials may have additional restrictions.

In the Blackhearts, a well-kept blade may save your life. A neglected one may end it.